Zeporah Workflow 5: Immediate Post-Death Guidance and Funeral-Period Coordination

Version: 1.0 — Fully integrated product, operational, and handoff specification
Primary release context: Hospice and palliative-care pilot
Reusable contexts: Hospitals, senior living, skilled nursing, home health, funeral homes, cremation providers, cemeteries, life insurers, employers/EAPs, faith communities
Primary user: Family Coordinator
Supporting users: Co-Coordinator, Family Helper, Family Viewer, approved Partner Support Team
Prerequisites: Workflow 1 — Family Onboarding, Consent, Roles, Permissions, and Visual Trust System; Workflow 2 — Serious Illness and Hospice-Care Preparation; Workflow 3 — Family Coordination, Communication, Tasks, and Documents; Workflow 4 — Caregiver Overwhelm, Compassionate Pause, and Human-Support Escalation

1. Workflow purpose

1.1 Family problem

After someone dies, families may be in shock, exhausted, grieving, and suddenly responsible for practical decisions. The first hours and days can involve calling a hospice or facility, coordinating with family, honoring personal, cultural, spiritual, or religious wishes, selecting a funeral or cremation provider, telling people who need to know, caring for dependents or pets, securing the home, and managing immediate work or household needs.

The family may be receiving many calls, messages, documents, and opinions at once. One person often becomes the default organizer, even if they do not feel ready. A large generic "after a death checklist" can worsen the burden by presenting dozens of administrative tasks before the family has had space to process what happened.

Workflow 5 offers a paced, private, compassionate "Now, Next, Later" experience. It helps the Family Coordinator decide what is most important in the immediate period, share only necessary information with selected people, organize funeral-period responsibilities, access grief and practical support, and prepare for later life-administration work—without giving legal, financial, medical, religious, or funeral-service advice.

1.2 Family value

The Family Coordinator should be able to say:

- "I do not have to do every task today."
- "I know the few things that may matter right now, and I can leave the rest for later."
- "I can coordinate family help without sharing private information widely."

- “I can preserve and honor what mattered to my loved one without feeling pushed into decisions.”
- “I can find grief, spiritual, practical, or care-team support if I want it.”
- “I can keep an organized record for later without having to begin estate work immediately.”

1.3 Institutional value

For hospice, palliative-care organizations, senior-living communities, hospitals, funeral providers, insurers, employers, and faith communities, Workflow 5 can:

- Extend respectful family support at a moment when formal service interactions may be ending or changing.
- Give families an organized way to access approved bereavement, social-work, chaplaincy, practical, and family-support resources.
- Reduce duplicate nonclinical coordination contacts by helping a Family Coordinator organize selected updates, tasks, and contacts.
- Provide a clear, consented path for the family to request contact rather than relying on unstructured incoming calls.
- Support an organization’s family experience without giving it access to the family’s private coordination space.
- Create a bridge to longer-term bereavement, estate, benefits, and life-administration support in Workflow 6.

1.4 Scope

This workflow includes:

- Intentional transition into the recent-loss stage.
- Sensitive acknowledgement and choice to preserve, archive, or continue using earlier care-planning content.
- Immediate “Now” support: who is with the family, responsible care/facility contacts, immediate practical support, and selected urgent needs.
- Family update and notification coordination.
- Selected personal, spiritual, cultural, or religious wishes and remembrance information.
- Funeral, memorial, cremation, burial, or disposition coordination support at an organizational level, without provider pressure or service recommendation for compensation.
- Practical task coordination: dependents, pets, home/household, work/leave, travel, meals, visitor support, and selected immediate paperwork.
- Grief, emotional, spiritual, and bereavement support navigation.
- Document and information preservation for later—not immediate estate/legal processing.

- Consent-based connection requests to hospice bereavement, social work, chaplaincy, funeral provider where chosen, employer/EAP, insurer support, faith community, or other approved resource.
- Privacy, handoff, notification, accessibility, partner-operations, audit, exception, and integration requirements.

1.5 Out of scope

Workflow 5 does not:

- Confirm, certify, report, or legally register a death.
- Determine whether an emergency response, medical examiner, coroner, hospice, facility, physician, or other authority must be contacted.
- Provide legal advice on probate, wills, trusts, death certificates, property, taxes, debts, beneficiary designations, executor duties, or estate settlement.
- Provide financial, investment, tax, insurance-claim eligibility, or benefits advice.
- Provide funeral, cremation, burial, religious, or cultural advice as though there is one correct choice.
- Automatically refer or disclose family contact details to funeral providers, attorneys, insurers, clergy, grief counselors, or other resources.
- Sell paid placement, referrals, sponsorship, leads, or preferred ranking to providers.
- Force a family to discuss death, choose a funeral provider, upload documents, tell relatives, or begin estate tasks before they are ready.

2. Participants and responsibilities

Participant	Role in Workflow 5	Default authority
Family Coordinator	Chooses stage transition, controls privacy, prioritizes tasks, coordinates selected updates, decides whether to invite/share with helpers, and approves external requests.	Full control within Workflow 1 permissions
Co-Coordinator	Assists with immediate tasks, updates, contacts, and selected arrangements if authorized.	Configurable elevated access
Family Helper	Completes selected practical tasks, sees approved updates or documents, and can request help with assigned work.	Assigned/shared scope only
Family Viewer	Receives selected updates such as a death notification, memorial information, or practical request, without access to private logistics.	Selected updates only
Hospice/Partner Support Team	May receive a specific, family-approved request for bereavement, social work, chaplaincy, care-team, practical, employee, insurer, or other support.	No default access to private workspace
Zeporah System	Preserves prior information, offers staged pathways and support options, protects permissions, records consent, and provides gentle reminders.	No authority to decide family, legal, clinical, financial, cultural, or religious matters

3. Core design principles

3.1 Start with compassion, not a checklist

The first experience after a stage change must acknowledge loss before presenting tasks. The app should never open with “Complete these 35 tasks” or a countdown.

3.2 Now, Next, Later—not one large post-death plan

- **Now:** What may need attention in the next hours or day, based on family-selected situation.
- **Next:** What may be useful in the coming days, including arrangements, selected notifications, and practical support.
- **Later:** What can wait, including many financial, benefits, estate, property, and administrative tasks that Workflow 6 will pace over months.

3.3 Family control over language and timing

The Coordinator chooses whether the app uses the loved one’s name, “your loved one,” a selected relationship term, or another phrase. The family controls when and whether to notify people, share remembrance preferences, or begin arrangements.

3.4 No provider pressure

Zeporah can help a family identify the type of help they want and may show transparent resources. It must not treat grief as a lead-generation moment. Funeral, legal, financial, insurance, mental-health, spiritual, and practical resources cannot receive paid preference.

3.5 Preserve earlier information, do not force it forward

Contacts, values, tasks, notes, and documents from prior workflows remain available under existing permissions. Zeporah asks the Coordinator what, if anything, they wish to keep active, archive, share, or use in the recent-loss period.

3.6 Respect cultural, spiritual, religious, and family variation

The product asks, never assumes. It does not presume a funeral, burial, cremation, religious service, public obituary, family structure, financial capacity, or timeline.

4. Entry conditions and triggers

4.1 Primary entry triggers

- Family Coordinator intentionally changes journey stage to “They died recently.”
- Family Coordinator begins Zeporah after a death and selects “They died recently” in Workflow 1.
- Coordinator selects a recent-loss pathway from dashboard.
- A participating hospice, hospital, senior-living community, or other organization offers an optional recent-loss Zeporah invitation; the family chooses to begin.

4.2 Required confirmation for stage change

If changing from serious illness, palliative care, or hospice to recent loss, display:

> “We are so sorry for your loss. Are you ready to update your family space so Zeporah can show support for the time after a death?”

Actions:

- “Yes, update my family space.”
- “Not now.”
- “Keep my current space as it is.”

No partner, helper, hospice, hospital, insurer, or other resource is notified by this action.

4.3 Re-entry triggers

- Coordinator returns to immediate-loss dashboard.
- User opens a selected immediate task, update, arrangement planner, support card, or private information item.
- Helper opens assigned task.
- Coordinator receives private question, task status, document request, or voluntary support-request status.
- User receives a consented gentle reminder.

4.4 Entry rules

- Recent-loss content is shown only after intentional selection/confirmation by the Coordinator or person creating their own private workspace.
- A partner invitation does not establish that a death occurred; family chooses stage.
- Do not create a death-related notification to helpers based solely on journey-stage update.
- Do not preselect funeral provider, spiritual path, or financial/legal actions.

5. Workflow overview

```
Family intentionally enters recent-loss pathway
        ↓
Zeporah acknowledges loss and preserves existing family space
        ↓
Coordinator chooses: focus on now / share selected update / ask for support / return
        ↓
Address immediate support, selected contacts, and practical needs
        ↓
Coordinate family roles and arrangement-related tasks at family's pace
        ↓
Capture wishes, remembrance, and selected service information
        ↓
Save important information for later without forcing estate work
        ↓
Find grief, spiritual, practical, or partner support if desired
        ↓
Move gently into later bereavement and life-administration pathway when ready
```

The family can enter any section directly. Nothing requires the family to complete earlier steps or disclose information they do not wish to share.

6. Screen-by-screen workflow

Screen 1: Recent-loss welcome and transition

Trigger

Coordinator confirms transition to recent loss or enters recent-loss pathway.

Goal

Acknowledge loss, explain that nothing must be done immediately in the app, and give clear choices.

User-facing content

Title: "We are so sorry for your loss"

Body:

"You do not have to manage every responsibility today. Zeporah can help you focus on what matters right now, keep selected people informed, and find support when you want it."

Privacy message:

"Your family space remains private. Updating this stage does not notify anyone or share information with an organization."

Actions

- “Focus on what matters now.”
- “Share an update with selected people.”
- “Find support.”
- “Save and come back later.”

System behavior

- Preserve all existing care-plan content under current access settings.
- Display no estate, legal, insurance, funeral, or extensive administrative tasks until the user chooses a relevant area.
- “Save and come back later” returns to dashboard, with optional reminder only if user chooses one.

Screen 2: What matters right now?

Goal

Help Coordinator select a small immediate focus without presenting a universal checklist.

User-facing content

Title: “What would help most right now?”

Prompt: “Choose one, or choose ‘I am not sure.’ You can come back to everything else later.”

Choices

- “Make sure the right people know.”
- “Find support for my family today.”
- “Handle immediate practical needs.”
- “Start thinking about arrangements or remembrance.”
- “Keep important information together for later.”
- “I am not sure where to start.”

Response matrix

Choice	Next pathway
Make sure right people know	Screen 3: selected family update / notification plan
Find support today	Screen 9: support options
Immediate practical needs	Screen 5: immediate practical tasks

Choice	Next pathway
Arrangements/remembrance	Screen 6: arrangements and remembrance
Keep information together	Screen 8: private information for later
Not sure	Screen 2A: gentle guided choice

Save behavior

Selected focus becomes a private, editable “Now” card. It does not send notifications.

Screen 2A: Gentle guided choice

Trigger

Coordinator selects “I am not sure where to start.”

User-facing content

Title: “That is okay”

Body:

“You do not need to know the whole path right now. You can begin with one small thing, or you can leave this for later.”

Choices

- “Tell one person what I need.”
- “Ask for practical help today.”
- “Find someone to talk to.”
- “Write down one important detail for later.”
- “Save and return later.”

System behavior

- “Tell one person” opens selected update with one-recipient default.
- “Practical help” opens immediate task support.
- “Find someone to talk to” opens support options.
- “Write detail” opens private information note.
- “Save” suppresses nonessential prompt for 24 hours unless user reopens pathway.

Screen 3: Share selected update / notification plan

Goal

Help Coordinator communicate with selected people without forcing public announcement or broad disclosure.

User-facing content

Title: “Share an update when you are ready”

Body:

“You can tell only the people you choose. You can keep the message private, send it to one person, or share it with selected people in your family space.”

Update templates

All templates are optional/editable and never sent automatically.

- **Simple update:** “I wanted to let you know that [name/relationship] died on [optional date]. We are taking things one step at a time. I will share more when we are ready.”
- **Practical request:** “We could use help with [meals / child care / pet care / travel / visitors / another task] over the next few days. Please let me know privately if you can help.”
- **Service information later:** “We will share arrangements when they are confirmed. Thank you for giving our family time and space.”
- **No details:** “Our family is going through a loss. We are not ready to share details, but we appreciate your care.”

Recipients

- One person.
- Specific Helpers/Viewers.
- All selected family-space members.
- Save privately, do not send.

Response settings

- No response needed.
- Allow acknowledgment only.
- Allow private question to Coordinator.
- Allow volunteer response for linked practical task.

Actions

- “Preview update.”
- “Save privately.”
- “Send update.”
- “Discard draft.”

System behavior

Use Workflow 3 Family Update logic: no reply-all by default; private questions go only to Coordinator/authorized Co-Coordinator; recipient notifications contain no death details; update remains visible only to selected recipients; Coordinator can edit/remove with audit and appropriate recipient notice.

Screen 4: Immediate contacts and support around the family

Goal

Organize only the contacts that may be useful now, without telling the family whom they are required to call.

User-facing content

Title: “Who is supporting your family right now?”

Body:

“Add or review only the contacts that would be helpful today. You can keep them private or share each one with selected people.”

Contact categories

- Hospice bereavement contact.
- Hospice care team or after-hours number, if relevant.
- Facility or hospital contact.
- Funeral, cremation, cemetery, or memorial provider, if family chooses.
- Chaplain, clergy, faith, or spiritual support.
- Family/friend support.
- Employer, school, EAP, or leave contact.
- Child/dependent care support.
- Pet care support.
- Transportation or travel support.
- Other.

Inputs/actions

Use Workflow 3 contact logic: add name/organization/category; optional person/phone/email/hours/notes; default private; selected sharing only; save contact; add another; return.

Important boundary

“Zeporah can help you keep contacts together. It does not tell you which provider, arrangement, or path is right for your family.”

Screen 5: Immediate practical needs

Goal

Help Coordinator organize immediate household and family needs with small, delegable tasks.

User-facing content

Title: “What practical help would make today easier?”

Body:

“Choose only what matters now. You can keep tasks private, do them yourself, ask someone you trust, or find support outside your family.”

Suggested categories

- Be with family / visitor coordination.
- Meals and groceries.
- Child or dependent care.
- Pet care.
- Transportation, airport, or travel.
- Home and household check.
- Medications or belongings: “Contact the responsible care team or pharmacy for guidance if you are unsure what to do.”
- Notify employer, school, or community.
- Arrange time away from work/caregiving.
- Other.

Task fields

- Title.
- Optional details.
- Timing: Today / Tomorrow / This week / Later / Custom.
- Owner: Me / Specific person / Leave unassigned.
- Visibility: Only me / Assigned person / Selected people / All Helpers.
- Optional support need: “I do not have anyone to ask.”

Actions

- “Create task.”
- “Ask someone to help.”
- “Find outside support.”
- “Save for later.”

System behavior

Use Workflow 3 task and delegation controls. Task notification previews never disclose death details or sensitive content. If user selects no-one-to-ask, open Screen 9 without notifying a partner.

Screen 6: Arrangements, remembrance, and family wishes

Goal

Provide a neutral, family-controlled space to organize personal, spiritual, cultural, and practical thoughts around funeral, memorial, cremation, burial, disposition, or remembrance—without telling the family what to choose or pressing provider contact.

User-facing content

Title: “Arrangements and remembrance, when you are ready”

Body:

“Every family’s choices are personal. You can use this space to collect what matters, share only what you choose, and return later. Zeporah does not tell you which service, provider, tradition, or decision is right.”

Optional starting choices

- “We already have a provider or plan.”
- “We want to explore options later.”
- “We are considering a funeral, memorial, celebration of life, or gathering.”
- “We are considering cremation, burial, donation, or another option.”
- “We are not ready to decide.”
- “We want faith, spiritual, cultural, or personal guidance.”

System behavior

- Each choice opens optional organizational prompts, never required checkout, price comparison, or provider ranking.
- If user says they already have provider, they can add contact and tasks privately.
- If user explores options, Zeporah may show general questions to consider and transparent neutral resource types; it does not recommend a paid provider based on compensation.
- Faith/spiritual/cultural preference can trigger optional resource card or consent-based chaplain/clergy connection.

Optional organizational prompts

- “Who should be included in decisions?”
- “What did your loved one say mattered to them?”
- “Are there traditions, practices, music, readings, people, or places you want to remember?”
- “Would you like to create a list of people to notify when details are ready?”
- “What practical questions do you want to ask a provider or faith/spiritual support person?”
- “What can wait until later?”

Actions

- “Save privately.”
- “Share with selected family.”
- “Turn this into a task.”
- “Find general support or resources.”
- “Not now.”

Family-entered wishes boundary

“This is a private family-organizing space. It is not a legal document, a binding instruction, or a substitute for speaking with the relevant provider or authority.”

Screen 7: General funeral/memorial resource navigation

Trigger

User selects “Find general support or resources,” “Explore options later,” or asks for provider/resource guidance.

Goal

Help family understand types of questions and support available, with transparent resource navigation and no pay-to-play ranking.

User-facing content

Title: “Support for arrangements, at your pace”

Body:

“You can save this for later. Zeporah can help you prepare questions and find transparent resources, but it does not choose a provider or arrangement for you.”

Options

- “Questions to bring to a funeral or cremation provider.”
- “Questions about a memorial, gathering, or service.”
- “Faith, spiritual, or cultural support.”
- “Low-cost or community support options, where available.”
- “Veteran, military, or community benefits information, where relevant.”
- “Find a provider contact independently.”
- “Request a connection,” only when an approved, transparent pathway is available.

Question prompts

Examples are written as questions—not advice:

- “What services and options are available, and what are the costs?”
- “Which decisions need to be made now, and which can wait?”
- “What documents or information should we bring?”
- “What accommodations are available for our family’s faith, culture, language, accessibility, or budget needs?”
- “Who will be our point of contact?”

System behavior

- General information/resources can be saved privately.
- Independent contact shares no user data.
- Request connection uses Screen 10 consent flow.
- Any provider/resource card displays relationship classification and verified cost information where possible.

Screen 8: Preserve information for later

Goal

Let family capture and protect information that may help later without pushing immediate estate administration.

User-facing content

Title: “Keep important information together for later”

Body:

“You do not need to handle everything now. If it helps, you can make a private list of information to return to when you are ready.”

Optional items

- Important contacts.
- Funeral/memorial information.
- Certificates or documents to ask about later.
- Employer, benefits, or insurance contacts.
- Legal, tax, or estate professional contacts, if applicable.
- Household, property, dependents, or pet-care information.
- Personal items, stories, photographs, or remembrance notes.
- Questions for a future professional.

Actions per item

- “I have this.”
- “I need to find this later.”
- “Ask someone to help.”
- “This does not apply.”
- “Not now.”

System behavior

- “I need to find this later” creates a later task without urgent deadline.
- “Ask someone to help” uses Workflow 3 task-only delegation and item-level sharing.
- Upload is optional and private by default.
- Zeporah does not tell users whether a document is legally required or evaluate its meaning.
- Items may flow into Workflow 6 when user chooses to begin later administration.

Screen 9: Grief, spiritual, practical, and bereavement support

Goal

Offer optional support without assuming the family needs therapy, religion, a specific type of grief response, or immediate contact.

User-facing content

Title: “Support for you and your family”

Body:

“Loss affects people differently. You can choose support for practical needs, grief, spiritual care, family support, work or leave, or simply save options for later. Nothing is shared unless you choose to send a request.”

Optional need choices

- “Talk with hospice bereavement support.”
- “Talk with a social worker or resource navigator.”
- “Talk with a chaplain, clergy, or spiritual-care person.”
- “Find grief support or a support group.”
- “Find practical help with meals, travel, child care, pets, or home needs.”
- “Get help with work, school, leave, or EAP resources.”
- “Find low-cost, community, veteran, or cultural support.”
- “I am not sure.”

Resource cards

Each card contains resource name, category, help description, why shown, relationship label, verified cost/access/language indicators, and Save/Hide/Contact independently/Request connection actions.

System behavior

- Show no more than four cards initially.
- User can save all options for later without taking action.
- Hidden resources follow shared recommendation suppression rules.
- A recommendation never creates partner contact, provider outreach, or marketing activity.
- Request connection opens Screen 10.

Screen 10: Request a support connection

Goal

Enable clear, explicit, minimum-necessary sharing when the family wants an organization or resource to reach out.

User-facing content

Title: “Request a connection”

Body:

“Zeporah can send a request to [recipient]. You choose what to share. Private notes, documents, family messages, tasks, and anything you do not select will not be included.”

Required fields

- Request type:
  - Hospice bereavement support.
  - Hospice care team/family support contact.
  - Social worker or resource navigation.
  - Chaplain, clergy, or spiritual care.
  - Practical caregiver/family support.
  - Funeral/memorial resource connection.
  - Employer, leave, EAP, or school support.
  - Insurer/member/beneficiary support.
  - Community, veteran, cultural, or low-cost support.
  - Help understanding who to contact.
  - Other.
- Preferred contact method.
- Preferred contact time.

Optional fields

- Preferred language.
- Short message written by Coordinator.
- Permission to leave voicemail/message.
- Broad reason such as grief support, practical support, arrangements, work/leave, or navigation.

Share preview

Will be shared

- Coordinator/requestor name.
- Request type.
- Preferred contact method and time.
- Preferred language if selected.
- Optional user-written message.
- Optional broad reason if selected.

Will not be shared

- Private notes.
- Documents.
- Family Updates.
- Full task list or task details.
- Contacts not selected for sharing.
- Other family member names/roles.
- Wishes/remembrance notes.
- Recommendation browsing/saving/hiding activity.
- Any information not explicitly selected.

Actions

- “Send my request.”
- “Save draft.”
- “Cancel.”

System behavior

- Require acknowledgment: “I understand Zeporah will send the information listed above to [recipient].”
- Log recipient, fields, consent time/version, request ID.
- Send only approved fields to partner/resource queue.
- Show plain request status; no partner receives continuing workspace access.
- Permit withdrawal before handling where operationally possible, with clear limitation after transmission.

Screen 11: Immediate-loss dashboard

Goal

Provide a calm home without forcing progression.

User-facing content

Title: “What matters now”

Subtext: “You can take this one step at a time.”

Sections

Now

- One user-selected immediate focus.
- One optional practical task.
- One optional support action.

Next

- Selected updates/notification plan.
- Arrangement/remembrance thoughts.
- Contacts or family tasks.

Later

- Information to save for later.
- Life-administration tasks when user chooses.
- Grief and anniversary support options.

Private and shared

- Visibility label on every item: Private, Shared, Assigned, or Request sent.

Actions

- “Share an update.”
- “Add task.”
- “Add contact.”
- “Write a remembrance note.”
- “Find support.”
- “Review who can see what.”
- “Save and return later.”

Status rules

- No completion percentage.
- No red overdue labels.
- No countdown to arrangements or official tasks.
- User-set dates display gently: “You chose to revisit this on [date].”
- If a date passes, ask “Would you like to keep this, choose a new time, or remove it?”

7. Decision and branching logic

7.1 Family starts Zeporah after a death

- Begin at Screen 1 without requiring prior care workflow completion.
- Create/reuse private workspace through Workflow 1.
- Ask only minimal stage/context preferences.
- Do not display prior care-plan content that does not exist.

7.2 Hospice or facility contact is needed

- Zeporah provides family-selected contact or verified partner contact where configured.
- If user wants contact from team, show support-request route and explicit consent.
- Do not infer that care team should be contacted because stage changed.

7.3 Family wants to notify relatives but not share details

- Use no-details template.
- Allow one-recipient message or selected recipients.
- Default no response or acknowledgment-only.
- Never force public announcement or obituary workflow.

7.4 Family has arrangement provider already

- Add provider contact privately.
- Create selected tasks/questions.
- Do not show competing providers or marketplace options.
- Offer support for organizing questions or sharing information only if requested.

7.5 Family does not know what type of arrangements they want

- Offer “not ready” and general question prompts.
- Offer faith/spiritual/cultural support if requested.
- Show neutral resource types, not ranked paid providers.
- Do not require decision before other support paths.

7.6 Family faces financial or practical difficulty

- Offer optional community, nonprofit, employer, veteran, benefits-navigation, or low-cost resource categories when configured and verified.
- Do not provide financial advice, claim eligibility, legal advice, or recommendations based on financial-product compensation.

7.7 Family conflict or disagreement

- Keep private notes and requests private to their author/Coordinator scope.
- Coordinator can limit update recipients, pause invitations, choose task-specific access, or avoid sharing personal wishes broadly.
- Offer support option for social worker/family support where configured, with consent.
- Do not mediate, decide, or disclose conflict automatically.

7.8 User is overwhelmed

- Route to Workflow 4 compassionate pause.
- Preserve current draft and stage context.
- Offer smaller step, delay, trusted helper, or support request.

7.9 User is ready for later administration

- User selects “Keep important information together for later,” “Life after loss,” or a later task.
- Route to Workflow 6 with pacing; do not automatically activate all estate/benefit tasks.

8. Permissions and privacy rules

8.1 Object-level visibility

Object	Default visibility	Potential sharing
Recent-loss stage	Coordinator/family-facing workspace context	Never external by default; Coordinator may choose selected update
Death-related Family Update	Private draft	Selected people / selected Helpers/Viewers
Immediate task	Coordinator only	Assigned person / specific people / all Helpers
Arrangement/remembrance note	Coordinator only	Specific people if chosen
Contact	Coordinator only	Specific people / all Helpers
Document	Only me	Coordinator/Co-Coordinator / specific people / all Helpers
Support-request draft/status	Coordinator only	Coordinator may share plain summary
Private question/request	Coordinator inbox only	Private response or selected shared update only

8.2 Sensitive sharing requirements

- Adding an attachment to an update requires item-level permission check.
- Sharing personal wishes/remembrance note requires explicit recipient selection and preview.
- Sharing a document requires document-specific access selection; Helpers have no download permission by default.
- An external support request requires recipient, data preview, and explicit consent.

8.3 Partner boundary

No partner sees recent-loss stage, family updates, arrangement notes, tasks, contacts, documents, private questions, family conflict, resource activity, or other family information by default. A partner sees only the specific fields approved in one request.

9. Notifications and reminders

9.1 Principles

- No sensitive death or arrangement information in lock-screen, SMS, or email previews.
- Use only channels and frequencies user has chosen.
- Respect quiet hours.
- Avoid reminders during the first 24 hours after recent-loss stage selection unless user explicitly requests them or a security notice is needed.

- Never notify helpers or partner because Coordinator changed stage.

9.2 Notification catalogue

Event	Recipient	Default notification	Conditions
Selected update sent	Chosen recipient	“There is a new update in a Zeporah family space.”	No death details in preview
Update acknowledgment	Coordinator	“[Name] acknowledged your update.”	If acknowledgments enabled
Private question	Coordinator	“You have a private family question.”	No content in preview
Task assigned	Helper	“You have a new task in a Zeporah family space.”	No task/death details
Task completed/needs help	Coordinator	“A task has an update.”	Detail only in authenticated app
Support request sent	Coordinator/requestor	“Your support request was sent.”	Immediate
Support request status	Coordinator/requestor	“Your support request was acknowledged.”	Partner status only
User-selected reminder	User	“When you are ready, one small next step is here.”	After 24-hour quiet period unless user selects sooner
Gentle return	User	“When you are ready, Zeporah is here.”	Only with consent

10. Compassionate pause and urgent-help boundary

10.1 Pause behavior

Every nonurgent screen includes Save, Not now, or return-later option. On pause:

“Your progress is saved. You do not have to decide this today.”

Do not interpret pause as emotional state or notify anyone. Re-entry offers current item, smaller step, support, or leave-for-later choice.

10.2 Overwhelm

Route to Workflow 4. Preserve draft. Use language:

“This is a lot to carry. You can make this smaller, ask someone to help, find support, or come back later.”

10.3 Urgent-help boundary

If user selects explicit urgent-help action:

“If someone is in immediate danger or needs urgent medical help, call local emergency services now. If hospice is involved, you can also contact the hospice’s 24-hour line.”

Display verified line only. State: “Zeporah cannot monitor emergencies, provide emergency response, or determine what level of medical care is needed.”

No auto-call, auto-notification, triage, risk scoring, or monitoring.

11. Partner operational workflow

11.1 Pre-launch configuration

Participating partner configures organization/program identity, verified contact guidance, accepted request categories, queues and accountable staff roles, hours and response targets if committed, after-hours instructions, escalation owner, bereavement and support resources, external-resource governance, language/accessibility pathways, data-sharing agreement, and request withdrawal/unavailable-service process.

11.2 Request routing matrix

Request category	Default destination	Partner action
Hospice bereavement	Bereavement team	Contact family per program policy and selected preference
Care team/family support	Hospice/facility/hospital family-support queue	Provide appropriate non-emergency contact path
Social worker/resource navigation	Social-work/resource queue	Help with practical and psychosocial resources within scope
Chaplain/spiritual care	Spiritual-care queue	Contact according to preference/availability
Practical support	Volunteer/social work/resource coordination	Share/arrange available support, no guarantee until confirmed
Funeral/memorial connection	Transparent approved resource path	Contact only with consent; no paid placement influence
Employer/EAP/school	Benefits/EAP/HR support route	Explain pathway within service scope
Insurer/member/beneficiary	Member/beneficiary support queue	Provide applicable service contact; no claim/eligibility determination through Zeporah
Community/veteran/cultural support	Approved community-navigation route	Provide verified resource path

11.3 Partner queue fields

Only consented request ID, category, Coordinator/requestor name, preferred contact method/time, language if selected, optional message, broad reason if selected, timestamp, and program ID.

11.4 Partner cannot see

No stage update, updates, tasks, contacts, notes, documents, arrangement/remembrance content, family identities/roles, browsing history, support preferences, conflict details, reminder status, or audit history beyond request receipt/status.

11.5 Partner statuses

Received; Acknowledged; Contact attempted; Connected; Referred; Closed—no longer needed; Closed—unable to reach; Closed—service unavailable. Family sees only plain status, no staff notes/clinical info/internal operations.

12. Exceptions and edge cases

- **Stage changed in error:** Confirm before change; allow immediate correction; no notice to anyone.
- **Death occurred before family completed care plan:** Preserve workspace; recent-loss flow works with missing data; do not require retrospective completion.
- **Family does not know who needs notification:** Offer save for later, one-person update, or private contact list; no required list.
- **No funeral/memorial desired:** User can mark not applicable; app does not reprompt aggressively.
- **No provider selected:** Keep options neutral; no marketplace pressure; offer general questions/resources later.
- **Provider already selected:** Add contact/tasks; do not show competitors.
- **Wrong update recipient:** Allow remove/edit; explain read/download cannot be undone; audit correction.
- **Family member disputes access/wishes:** Coordinator manages access; Zeporah does not determine authority; offer safe privacy controls and support options.
- **No money/transport/nearby support:** Offer configured low-cost/community/virtual options; do not promise availability.
- **Partner does not provide requested service:** Show unavailable status and alternate approved resources where possible.
- **No internet:** Save draft locally only when secure/supported; show unsent state; never claim sent without confirmation.
- **User has language/accessibility needs:** Apply selected preferences; accurately show partner resource capabilities; offer alternate method where configured.

- **User is minor or authority unclear:** Follow product policy; do not assume authority; show appropriate support path.
- **User includes credentials/sensitive data:** Warn before save/send; do not include beyond explicit preview; follow security policy.

13. Data minimization, analytics, and acceptance criteria

13.1 Data minimization

Collect only user-entered selected updates, tasks, contacts, arrangement/remembrance notes, saved information status, support preferences, and consented request data. Do not require death certificate, cause/date/location of death, medical record, diagnosis, SSN, financial account information, legal documents, insurance policy numbers, probate information, or funeral-provider commitment.

All new items are private by default. Documents require explicit sharing. Partner receives only consent-preview fields. De-identify/aggregate analytics where feasible.

13.2 Family measures

- Recent-loss pathway activation and return rate.
- Percentage selecting one immediate focus rather than abandoning initial screen.
- Selected-update completion and private-question rate.
- Immediate task creation, delegation, completion, and deferral rate.
- Support-resource save/hide/independent contact/connection-request rate.
- User-reported sense of control, clarity, compassion, and privacy understanding.
- Use of pause/return and transition to Workflow 6 when ready.

13.3 Organization measures

- Voluntary bereavement/family-support request volume by category.
- Request completeness, acknowledgment, and connection time.
- Family satisfaction with access to support.
- Resource relevance and availability rate.
- Repeat nonclinical contacts where lawfully/ethically measurable.
- Staff-reported clarity/appropriateness of routed requests.

13.4 Privacy and safety measures

- Update-recipient preview completion rate.
- Document/arrangement-note access changes and revocations.
- External share-preview and consent completion rate.
- Incorrect-recipient correction rate.
- Recommendation hide/opt-out rate.
- Urgent-help boundary display rate without inferring content.
- Audit completeness and unauthorized-access attempts.

13.5 Required audit events

- recent_loss_stage_change_started
- recent_loss_stage_change_confirmed
- recent_loss_stage_change_corrected
- recent_loss_pathway_opened
- immediate_focus_selected
- death_update_drafted
- death_update_sent
- death_update_edited
- death_update_removed
- arrangement_note_created
- arrangement_note_shared
- immediate_task_created
- immediate_task_assigned
- immediate_task_completed
- preserve_for_later_item_created
- support_recommendation_shown
- support_recommendation_saved
- support_recommendation_hidden
- bereavement_support_connection_started
- bereavement_support_share_preview_viewed
- bereavement_support_consent_confirmed
- bereavement_support_request_sent
- bereavement_support_request_withdrawn
- partner_request_status_updated
- compassionate_pause_opened

- urgent_help_boundary_shown
- workflow_6_transition_started

13.6 Acceptance criteria

Workflow 5 is ready for pilot only when:

1. Recent-loss stage requires intentional user selection/confirmation and does not notify anyone automatically.
2. First screen acknowledges loss before showing tasks and provides Save/return option.
3. Family can choose one immediate focus without seeing a broad administrative checklist.
4. Every family update has explicit recipients and no default reply-all.
5. Immediate tasks, contacts, documents, and wishes are private by default and have granular sharing.
6. Arrangement/remembrance area is neutral, optional, culturally flexible, and not influenced by provider payments.
7. Zeporah does not provide legal, financial, tax, insurance, funeral, or emergency advice.
8. Support recommendations are transparent, need-led, user-controlled, and non-pay-to-play.
9. Every external contact request displays recipient and exact data shared, requires explicit consent, and grants no ongoing partner access.
10. Urgent-help messaging clearly directs users to emergency services/responsible care line and states Zeporah's limitation.
11. Family can preserve information for later without beginning estate administration.
12. Workflow preserves permissions, tasks, contacts, documents, and support settings from earlier workflows.
13. Partner receives only consented minimum data and returns limited status.
14. Mobile, accessibility, plain-language, low-bandwidth, audit, and measurement requirements are met.

14. Workflow integration and handoffs

14.1 Integration purpose

Workflow 5 is the intentional transition from serious illness/care coordination to the immediate period after a death. It does not erase the family's prior Zeporah space. It preserves earlier information under existing permissions and helps the family decide what remains useful now, what can be archived, and what should wait for later life administration.

The family experiences one continuous private space. The product changes its tone and priorities after the Coordinator's intentional stage change, but it does not automatically declare a death to others, expose historical information, or begin estate work.

14.2 What enters Workflow 5

Entering object/context	Source	How Workflow 5 uses it
Workspace ID and authenticated user	Workflow 1/shared platform	Associates recent-loss items with correct private family space and validates current access
Roles and permissions	Workflow 1; updated via Workflow 3	Controls who can see/update immediate tasks, updates, contacts, and documents
Privacy defaults and item access settings	Workflow 1/3	Keeps prior and new content private by default; preserves item-level sharing
Journey state and intentional change confirmation	Workflow 1/2/Coordinator action	Activates recent-loss content only after user choice; never confirms death from partner data
Care/support contacts	Workflow 2/3	Makes existing hospice, social-work, chaplaincy, facility, family, and practical contacts available under current scope
Questions, family-entered notes, values/preferences	Workflow 2	Allows family to optionally reference what mattered, support preferences, and selected practical information; not externally shared by default
Tasks, updates, documents, inbox items	Workflow 3	Carries forward relevant ongoing tasks and controlled collaboration history; no broad exposure
Pause/reminder/support preferences	Workflow 4	Preserves user pacing and recommendation controls
Existing support requests/status	Workflow 4/shared service	Shows family's own status; does not create partner access to new Workflow 5 content
Optional loved-one name, relationship, language/accessibility/location preferences	Workflow 1	Personalizes family-facing wording and resource matching only
Partner connection/request configuration	Workflow 1/partner setup	Enables voluntary approved request paths only

14.3 What Workflow 5 creates or updates

Object/setting	Created or updated	Default visibility	Controller
Recent-loss journey state	Confirmed stage and timing context	Family-facing workspace context	Coordinator
Immediate focus	Selected Now priority	Coordinator only	Coordinator
Death-related Family Update	Recipient-specific update and response setting	Private draft	Coordinator/authorized Co-Coordinator
Immediate task	Household, family, travel, visitor, arrangement, or support task	Coordinator only	Coordinator/authorized Co-Coordinator
Immediate contacts	Selected bereavement, arrangement, family, work, practical contacts	Coordinator only	Coordinator/authorized role
Arrangement/remembrance note	Family-entered wishes, questions, and planning thoughts	Coordinator only	Coordinator

Object/setting	Created or updated	Default visibility	Controller
Arrangement/resource preference	User-selected types of information/support desired	Coordinator/user context	Coordinator/user
Preserve-for-later item	Document/contact/task/question to revisit later	Coordinator only	Coordinator
Bereavement/practical support need	Optional stated category	Coordinator/user scope	User/Coordinator
Support-request draft	Recipient/category/contact preferences/message	Coordinator only	Coordinator
Support-request consent record	Exact fields, recipient, time/version, request ID	System audit	System-managed
Transition/archival choices	Keep active, archive, defer, or convert prior item	Item-level scope	Coordinator

14.4 What Workflow 5 sends forward

Object/capability available later	Later workflow(s)	Conditions/use
Confirmed recent-loss state and timing context	Workflow 6; shared dashboard	Paces later guidance; not partner-visible
Immediate tasks/status/owners	Workflow 3 and Workflow 6	Retain current permissions; may stay active or be deferred
Selected Family Updates and recipients	Workflow 3 history/Workflow 6 as appropriate	Available only to authorized recipients; not partner-visible
Arrangement/remembrance notes	Workflow 6 and family history	Remain private unless explicitly shared; not legal/binding instructions
Contacts	Workflow 3 and Workflow 6	Reused for follow-up, benefits, practical, or support tasks under item access rules
Preserve-for-later items	Workflow 6	Surface only when family chooses/later pacing triggers; no automatic deadlines
Support needs/preferences and saved/hidden resource history	Recommendation service/Workflow 4/6	Tailor optional support; no auto-referral
Submitted support-request summary/status	Workflow 4/6	Family sees limited status; recipient sees only one request
Archived prior care-plan items	Family archive/Workflow 6 if restored	Not automatically visible to new users/partners
Updated permissions/sharing rules	Workflows 1–6	Current scope controls later access
Consent/audit records	System layer	Preserve governance; no historic consent reuse

14.5 What remains private or inactive

- Stage change itself is not sent to partner, hospice, hospital, helper, viewer, funeral provider, insurer, employer, or other resource.
- Earlier care notes, questions, contacts, preferences, documents, and tasks remain at their original access scope; they are not broadly shared because the family enters recent loss.
- Arrangement/remembrance notes remain private and are not sent to providers, clergy, or family without explicit sharing.
- A family update remains private draft until Coordinator selects recipients and sends it.
- A practical task is not visible to a helper until assigned/shared.
- Support browsing, saved/hidden resources, pause behavior, and grief/support preferences do not create referrals, leads, payments, or notifications.
- A submitted request does not give recipient ongoing workspace access, future arrangement information, or private family history.
- Existing consent for prior hospice/care support does not authorize bereavement, funeral, insurer, legal, or other new contact; each external request requires its own recipient/data consent.
- Estate, benefits, legal, financial, and insurance tasks remain inactive until the family intentionally opens Workflow 6 or selects an individual task.

14.6 What triggers another workflow

Trigger in Workflow 5	Resulting workflow/capability	Required continuation behavior
Coordinator creates/assigns immediate task, shares update, manages contact/document	Workflow 3 coordination	Preserve item scope; use controlled updates/task-only delegation
User pauses, feels overwhelmed, lacks support, task feels too large, or needs human help	Workflow 4 compassionate pause/support	Save draft; offer smaller step/delegation/support; no automatic contact
User requests bereavement, social work, chaplaincy, practical, insurer, EAP, or other support	Consent-based support service governed by Workflow 4	Show recipient/exact fields; explicit consent required
User wants to revisit care questions/contacts or needs care-team contextual information	Workflow 2 as relevant	Open only permitted prior care item; no auto-sharing
Coordinator selects “Life after loss,” preserve-for-later item, estate/benefits task, or later administration	Workflow 6	Show paced later path; retain access controls; do not activate all tasks at once
Coordinator changes family access/role	Workflow 1 governance service	Apply permission update across all current/later items
Partner sends limited request status	Workflow 4 status view / Workflow 5 dashboard	Display plain status only

14.7 What the family sees

The family never sees “Workflow 5,” “handoff,” “module,” or technical transition labels. They see a gentle continuation:

- “We are so sorry for your loss.”
- “What matters right now?”
- “Share an update when you are ready.”
- “Arrangements and remembrance, when you are ready.”
- “Keep important information together for later.”
- “Support for you and your family.”

Examples:

- After stage change: “Your family space is still here. You can focus on one thing now and return to everything else later.”
- After saving a remembrance note: “This is saved privately. You can share it, turn it into a task, or leave it here for later.”
- After a task is too much: “This is a lot to carry. You can make this smaller, ask someone to help, find support, or come back later.”
- Before later administration: “You do not need to begin these responsibilities now. When you are ready, we can help you choose one next step.”

The family sees one private Zeporah space where people, tasks, contacts, documents, support choices, and prior information remain organized under their chosen sharing rules.

14.8 What a partner sees

A partner sees only a Coordinator-initiated, consented request. For a single request, it may see request ID, selected request type, Coordinator/requestor name, preferred contact method/time, language if selected, optional user message, optional broad reason, timestamp, and program ID.

A partner does not see recent-loss stage, death-related update, recipients, arrangement/remembrance notes, tasks, task status, documents, contacts, family identities/roles, care-plan history, preferences, support browsing, saved/hidden resources, pause/reminder behavior, conflict information, notification activity, or general audit history.

A partner may return only limited status: received, acknowledged, contact attempted, connected, referred, closed—no longer needed, closed—unable to reach, or closed—service unavailable. Staff notes, clinical information, internal processes, and third-party information are not displayed in the family workspace.

15. Handoff to other workflows

Handoff to Workflow 3: Family Coordination, Communication, Tasks, and Documents

Trigger: Coordinator shares update, creates/assigns task, adds/shares contact, manages document, or asks family member to help.

Information available: Selected task/update/contact/document, item-level visibility, current roles, recipient settings, and existing permission rules.

Not automatically shared: Full recent-loss context, arrangement notes, private preferences, support requests, or other unrelated information.

Family-facing continuation: “You can share only what this person needs. They will see only the update, task, contact, or document you approve.”

Handoff to Workflow 4: Caregiver Overwhelm, Compassionate Pause, and Human-Support Escalation

Trigger: User selects Not now/I need help, task too large, no-one-to-ask, finds support, or requests connection.

Information available: Preserved draft/current item under current scope; user-selected support category; resource preferences; partner request options.

Not automatically shared: Grief state, private arrangement content, family conflict, task/update details, documents, or other family identities.

Family-facing continuation: “This is a lot to carry. Your progress is saved. You can make this smaller, ask someone to help, find support, or return later.”

Handoff to Workflow 6: First-Year Bereavement, Estate, Benefits, and Life-Administration Navigation

Trigger: Coordinator selects Life after loss, opens preserve-for-later item, chooses estate/benefits/admin topic, or completes immediate period and chooses later support.

Information retained: Roles/permissions; relevant contacts, tasks, documents, arrangement/remembrance notes, saved information, support preferences, resource history, and request status under original scopes. Historic consent is never reused for new external handoff.

Family-facing continuation: “You do not need to do everything at once. Choose one next step for today, and return to anything else later.”

Handoff to Workflow 2: Serious Illness and Hospice-Care Preparation

Trigger: Family intentionally opens a prior care contact, question, or note to reference information, or needs to prepare a care-team question where relevant.

Information available: Only user-permitted prior care objects and existing contact access. No new sharing is created.

Family-facing continuation: “This information is still here for your family. You can keep it private, share it with someone you trust, or return to what matters now.”